

Proposed Rough Syllabus for Moral Theology Course

Fall 2026

Main texts: *Morality: The Catholic View* by Servais Pinckaers, OP

Introducing Moral Theology: True Happiness and the Virtues by William C. Mattison III

Other Readings:

Veritatis Splendor by St. John Paul II

And other miscellaneous readings to be assigned.

Week 1: August 22, 2026

Topic 1: Foundations of Moral Theology in the Old Testament (the Prophets, Ten Commandments) and Greek Philosophy

- A) Book of Amos and Social Justice
- B) Amos: Religion & Morality Are The Same
- C) Ten Commandments: Blueprint for Morality and Religion
- D) Aristotle and Morality

Topic 2: Foundations of Moral Theology in the New Testament (the Gospels, Beatitudes, Epistles of St. Paul) and the Apostolic Era (Didache, etc.)

- A) Sermon on the Mount: Jesus Begins His Ministry with Emphasis on Morality
- B) Gospel of Luke: Good Samaritan: To be a Disciple is to Love Neighbor
- C) St. Paul's Letters to the Romans & Corinthians: Against Immoral Living in Greco-Roman Society
- D) Didache: One of the Earliest Non-Biblical Apostolic Sources of Morality

Readings: Mattison ch. 1

Pinckaers ch. 1, 2, 3

Week 2: September 12, 2026

Topic 1: Types of Law: Natural Law, Divine Law, Civil Law

- A) Book of Amos & Other Prophets: Appealing to Natural Law to Speak to Pagan Nations
- B) Natural Law as the Foundation of all Law
- C) Natural Law as Evidence that Human Nature is Fundamentally Good (despite sin)

D) Civil Law: Should Reflect Natural Law

Topic 2: Virtue and Happiness, Intentions, Good Acts, and Human Freedom

Readings: Mattison ch. 2, 3

Pinckaers ch. 6, 8

Week 3: October 3, 2026

Topic 1: The Virtues: Temperance, Prudence, Fortitude

Topic 2: The Virtues: Faith, Hope, Charity

Readings: Mattison ch. 4, 5, 9, 11, 13, 15

Week 4: November 7, 2026

Topic 1: Sin and its Effects

Topic 2: Grace, the Incarnation, the Holy Spirit, and their Effects for the Moral Life

Readings: Mattison ch. 12

Pinckaers ch. 7

Week 5: December 5, 2026

Topic 1: The Principle of Double Effect

Topic 2: Moral Theology Since Vatican II

Readings: Pinckaers ch. 4, 5